

Snippets

Consul expands into solar power

Consul Consolidated, an Indian manufacturer of UPS systems and voltage stabilisers, has acquired a controlling stake in Megatech Power Equipments—a solar power pack, inverter and UPS manufacturer based in Pune.

Addition of Megatech will enable Consul to further strengthen its business in the Indian power electronics market. Consul will leverage Megatech's power electronics product development capability with further investments in R&D and develop it as the power electronics centre of excellence for Consul.

Welspun plans solar-based research lab

Welspun Energy plans to set up a research lab in Gujarat in order to undertake further study on solar and offer technological advancements. The company will partner Gandhinagar-based Gujarat Energy Research and Management Institute (GERMI) to set up this lab where different solar technologies will be studied for their performance in Indian terrain and climatic conditions. Welspun has also signed an MoU with Pandit Deendayal Petroleum University.

The Analog kits will allow engineering students to build and test a wide range of analogue and digital circuits outside their university labs, using their own PC without the need for any additional lab equipment like oscilloscopes, waveform generators, logic analysers and power supplies. Students will also have easy access to online and downloadable software and teaching materials, circuit simulation tools, online support, textbooks, reference designs and lab projects to design and implement analogue circuits as a supplement to their core engineering curriculum.

Noida to have its own solar power plant

The Noida Board has approved a 1MW solar power generation plant on the UP irrigation possession land along Yamuna bank and Noida drain.

"Later, more plants will be set up in the city," informed Sanjiv Saran, Noida Board CEO.

Talking about the status of solar energy project in the state, he informed that such efforts have been undertaken in at least 2000 villages across 46 districts in Uttar Pradesh, mainly for lighting the streets after sunset.

At least a hundred telecom towers in Uttar Pradesh are also equipped with solar energy panels. In Noida, many traffic signals are run on solar energy, Saran added.

Karnataka govt partners Tata Teleservices

The Karnataka government has joined hands with Tata Teleservices and MMP Mobi Wallet Systems Ltd (MMPL), the mobile payments arm of Tata Teleservices Ltd, to launch an mGovernance pilot project in the state.

MMPL enables the government to accept payments from residents through the use of mRupee—a prepaid wallet service where mobile customers can register for this wallet and then load it with cash at designated mRupee retail outlets. They can then use this wallet balance to pay for mGovernance services like bill payments from the convenience of their home anytime.

The service allows residents to pay for electricity bills, property tax, water bill, traffic challan plus many more services of the state government. Tata Teleservices provides USSD connectivity for residents to access these services.

RCOM and Alcatel-Lucent join hands

Reliance Communications (RCOM) and Alcatel-Lucent have inked an end-to-end network managed services contract to deliver superior customer experience in Eastern and Southern India up to 2020.

As per the contract, Alcatel-Lucent will enhance RCOM's operations, and synergise hitherto independent wireless and wireline teams to form a single network management organisation. This optimised

integration of resources will help RCOM to strengthen focus on growing its business with top-of-the-line services to customers. Alcatel-Lucent would also drive a standardisation of tools, processes and best practices that are applied across RCOM's businesses.

IEEE sets up Smart Grid TAG

Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE)—a professional organisation dedicated to advancing technology for humanity—has announced formation of the IEEE 802.24 Smart Grid Technical Advisory Group (TAG).

The newly launched entity is a collaborative set-up that works with multiple IEEE 802 working groups and will liaise with key smart grid ecosystem stakeholders, such as regulatory agencies, other standards development bodies and industry organisations. Its goal is to help resolve questions and challenges regarding the use of IEEE 802 standards in smart grid applications.

"With the smart grid's continued evolution, IEEE 802 standards will play a fundamental role in critical applications like home automation, advanced metering infrastructures, renewable integration and demand response. IEEE 802.24 Smart Grid TAG will serve as the ultimate resource for practical information and insight about the use of IEEE 802 standards in the smart grid," said Bill Ash, strategic programme manager, IEEE Standards Association (IEEE-SA).

Over half a million Raspberry Pi's shipped: element14

Electronic components distributor element14 has inked a new distribution deal with the Raspberry Pi Foundation to sell its credit-card sized computer around the world. Almost a year since the launch of Raspberry Pi, more than half a million Raspberry Pi computers have rolled off the element14 production line.

Mike Buffham, global head of EDE at element14, said, "We are delighted to have signed a new global contract with the Raspberry Pi Foundation to continue to play a pivotal role in putting computer programming back at the heart of engineers—both young and old."

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